

You can pass a `Path` object to any function in the Python standard library that expects a filename. For example, the function call `open(Path('C:\\') / 'Users' / 'Al' / 'Desktop' / 'spam.py')` is equivalent to `open(r'C:\Users\Al\Desktop\spam.py')`.

The Home Directory

All users have a folder called the *home folder* or *home directory* for their own files on the computer. You can get a `Path` object of the home folder by calling `Path.home()`:

```
>>> Path.home()
WindowsPath('C:/Users/Al')
```

The home directories are located in a set place depending on your operating system:

- On Windows, home directories are in *C:\Users*.
- On Mac, home directories are in */Users*.
- On Linux, home directories are often in */home*.

Your scripts will almost certainly have permissions to read from and write to the files in your home directory, so it's an ideal place to store the files that your Python programs will work with.

The Current Working Directory

Every program that runs on your computer has a *current working directory* (*cwd*). Any filenames or paths that don't begin with the root folder you can assume are in the *cwd*. Although “folder” is the more modern name for a directory, note that *cwd* (or just working directory) is the standard term, not “current working folder.”

You can get the *cwd* as a `Path` object using the `Path.cwd()` function and change it using `os.chdir()`. Enter the following into the interactive shell:

```
>>> from pathlib import Path
>>> import os
```
